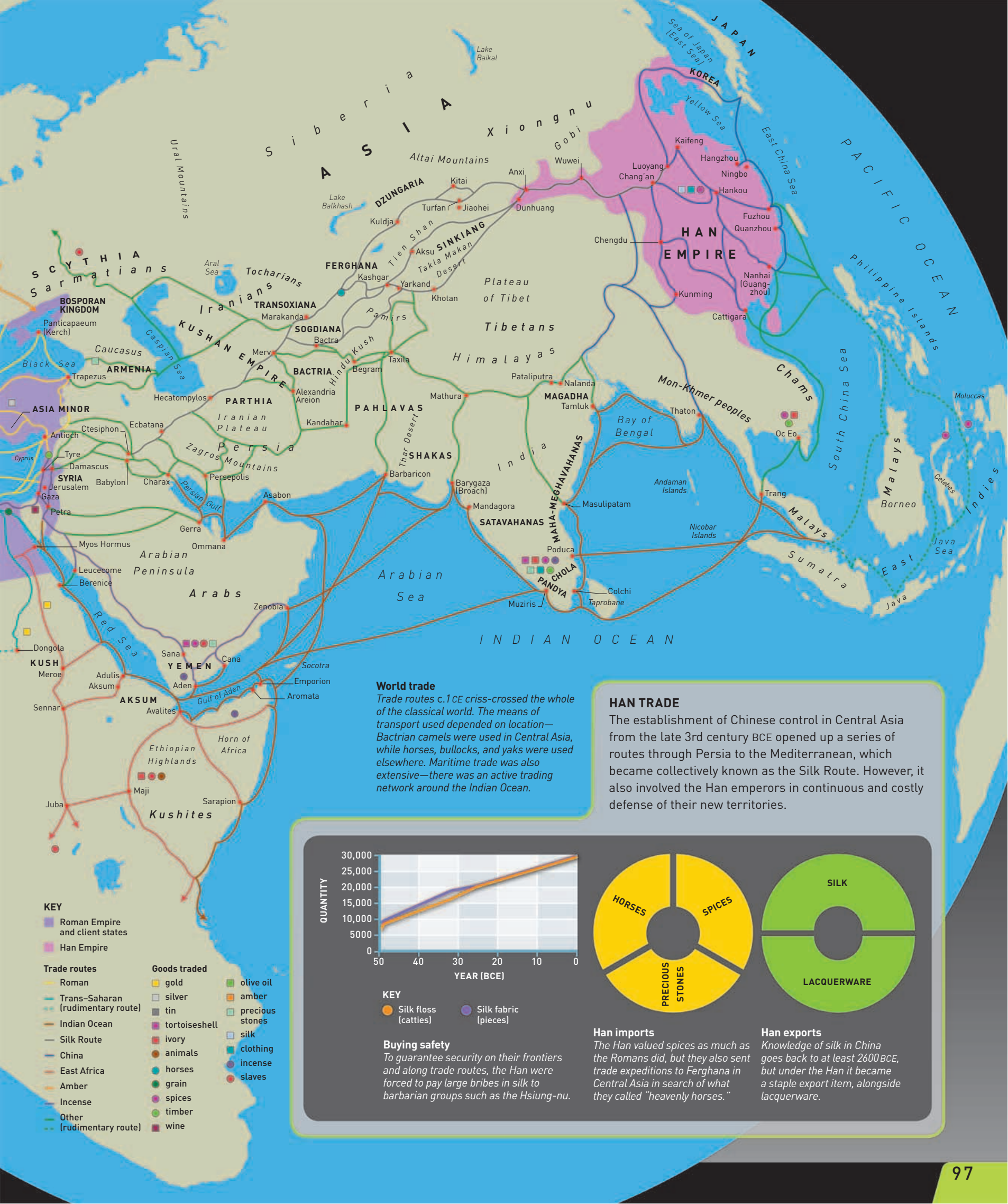


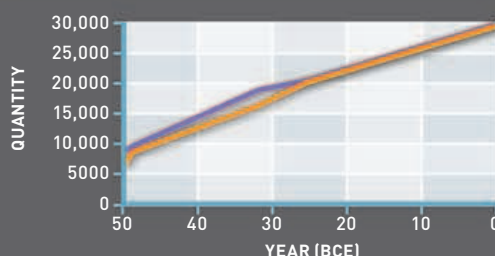


World trade

Trade routes c.1CE criss-crossed the whole of the classical world. The means of transport used depended on location—Bactrian camels were used in Central Asia, while horses, bullocks, and yaks were used elsewhere. Maritime trade was also extensive—there was an active trading network around the Indian Ocean.

HAN TRADE

The establishment of Chinese control in Central Asia from the late 3rd century BCE opened up a series of routes through Persia to the Mediterranean, which became collectively known as the Silk Route. However, it also involved the Han emperors in continuous and costly defense of their new territories.



KEY
Silk floss (catties)
Silk fabric (pieces)

Buying safety

To guarantee security on their frontiers and along trade routes, the Han were forced to pay large bribes in silk to barbarian groups such as the Hsiung-nu.



Han imports

The Han valued spices as much as the Romans did, but they also sent trade expeditions to Ferghana in Central Asia in search of what they called "heavenly horses."

Han exports

Knowledge of silk in China goes back to at least 2600 BCE, but under the Han it became a staple export item, alongside lacquerware.

KEY

- Roman Empire and client states
- Han Empire

Trade routes

- Roman
- Trans-Saharan (rudimentary route)
- Indian Ocean
- Silk Route
- China
- East Africa
- Amber
- Incense
- Other (rudimentary route)

Goods traded

- gold
- silver
- tin
- tortoiseshell
- ivory
- animals
- grain
- spices
- timber
- wine
- olive oil
- amber
- precious stones
- silk
- clothing
- incense
- slaves